

BUS 400:
Introduction to Business
Spring 2023 Syllabus
January 24th-May 15th
Hybrid: Online/F2F Format

Instructor Information

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Course Description

This class is an **Introduction to Business**. The primary objectives of this course are to give students:

1. A broad overview of what constitutes 'Business', in a variety of contexts.
2. A 'road map' for your further studies and courses in Business, as this course is the entry point for both the Business major and minor at UNHM.
3. Understanding the wide range of roles and impact that Business has on society.
4. An appreciation of the complexity of the world, and how Business fits into it.
5. New exciting ideas and trends, as the world of Business is incredibly dynamic, and global.
6. Developing an appreciation of roles you might plan in either starting or building a business.
7. Realizing the extremely important role that managers have in building and retaining an effective organization and work force.

We will deliberately cover the following areas of Business:

Accounting, Finance, Money, E-Commerce, Economics, Marketing, Operations Management, Ethics, Globalization, Human resources and Management, among a host of topics.

Business Program Student Learning Outcomes

Students will be engaged in intentional course assignments, activities, and experiences which will move students towards achieving proficiency in the following BA Business degree program Student Learning Outcomes. Specifically, students at the conclusion of this course, students will be able to demonstrate:

1. Ability to lead discussion groups and project teams to effective conclusions - written and oral, delivered in or out of the classroom.
2. Effective writing skills in all types of business and professional writing: memoranda, case studies, analytical and project reports.
3. Essential grasp of cogent presentation methods and techniques in the classroom, in front of visitors and peers.
4. Sensitivity to cultural differences and an appreciation for the diversity of human experience and perspectives.
5. Display professionalism in the workplace, in both service learning and internship contexts.

Faculty Details

Marisa earned her bachelor's degree in Psychology from Western New England College in Springfield, Massachusetts. She pursued her Master's Degree in Higher Education and Student Affairs at the University of Connecticut where she focused my work in leadership development and supporting academically at-risk students. Later, she completed her CAGS in Higher Education and Administrative Leadership from Plymouth State University where her research focused in the areas of communication, social justice, gender, and emotional intelligence. Her professional work began at UNH Manchester as an academic counselor and later as the Director of Student Development, coordinating orientation, first year transition programs, student leadership, and student academic support. Six years ago, after leaving her full-time position, she co-founded a consulting group, partnering with businesses to foster work place values, developing work place cultures, and delivering leadership development programming. In addition to her consulting work, given her teaching experience since 2007, she is now an adjunct faculty member at multiple institutions, developing curriculum and teaching courses in a variety of disciplines such as leadership, service learning, critical thinking, first year experience, gender, social justice, communication, and business. At UNH Manchester, Marisa has taught UMST and BUS courses including BUS 400, Introduction to Business; BUS 455, Human Resource Management; and BUS 640, Business Conflict and Communication. Marisa has also supported the UNH Manchester BUS 750/760 Business Senior Seminar capstone course for the last 13 years, co-instructing for the last 7 years.

Virtual Office Hours

Marisa is available 24/7 via email. All emails will be responded to within 24 hours, if not sooner. Virtual Office hours are available on Mondays 11:00-12:00pm, 5:00-6:00pm and Wednesdays 10:00-12:00pm and 5:00-6:00pm. To meet during this virtual availability or during another time, please contact Marisa at marisa.forti@unh.edu to arrange a meeting or phone appointment.

Course Materials

- Required Course Materials:
 - Business: A Changing World 13TH EDITION Copyright: 2022 By O. C. Ferrell and Geoffrey Hirt and Linda Ferrell
 - ISBN-13: 9781264067497
- Recommended Course Materials:
 - The Wall Street Journal: You will be provided articles to read for our classes. It is best to subscribe to the WSJ, for your ease of access and answering in depth topics. \$4 per month, paper, online or both.
 - The New York Times online you can read it through the UNH library with your wildcats login.
 - Also, read Ad Age (www.adage.com) to stay current on communications events and news. This is free, in the library (weekly). Other web sites and services will be suggested.
 - Various online articles will be sent to you as URL links as the course contents dictate.
 - Canvas, the University-wide information system, will be an integral source of information. mycourses.unh.edu. Our course is a hybrid course, with frequent online meetings. We will be utilizing My Courses for our online content delivery.
 - o By logging into Canvas students can access the syllabus, power point notes, additional readings, assignments, and grades.
 - o Given our course is hybrid, you will have assignments including discussion boards, that must be accessed and submitted through mycourses.
 - o If you do not have a Canvas account please contact the Campus IT department. A review of canvas will be given the first evening of class. All work that is graded should be uploaded on the course's Canvas site before our class meeting.

Seminar Protocol

Every person in this classroom is charged with the responsibility of creating an environment conducive to open, honest, and respectful communication among all participants. In order to achieve this goal, all students must regularly attend class meetings and participate in seminar activities and discussions, both in class and online. Your ideas, opinions, and personal knowledge are valuable resources for this class, and we encourage you to share them. In this course, we will be working together and everyone should have the opportunity to learn from this course. We should expect that each of us will bring our own point of view, which will be different from others'. For this reason, tolerance, open-mindedness, respect and trust are expected during the course, so that everyone can feel comfortable expressing themselves and learning from one another. Please refer to Discussion Board Participation for Netiquette guide to inform our Discussion Board communication. In the online learning component of our course, communication and responsiveness is key to having a productive and engaged learning experience. So:

- **Ask Me:** If you have a question, do not wait. If it is a general question, try posting it to the General Questions Discussion Board so other students can benefit from the conversation (and subscribe to this Discussion Board so you can benefit from your peers' questions). If you have questions specific to grading, feedback, or personal concerns: Send me an email, request a collaborate meeting, shoot me a text, or call me. Do it as soon as the question arises. Clarification is easier than the anxiety!
- **Tell Me:** If you have a concern, feedback, or personal issues that are affecting your ability to be successful in the course, communicate with me! I want to help support you as best as I can, but I can't if I don't know.
- **Share It:** Challenge yourself to share your experiences, opinions, and learnings. Learning occurs best when you are uncomfortable. I challenge you to push yourself, share an experience that you haven't shared broadly, give your opinion even if it contradicts someone else's, push yourself to read and research unfamiliar topics. Dig deep, share willingly, and challenge yourself. You will have a richer learning experience.
- **Help Me:** Let's create our Learning Community together. Engage in a professional manner. Support each other through compassion, respect, and understanding.

Style and Citations

Formal APA rules of scholarship and style (Publication Manual of the American Psychological Association, 7th edition) will apply to all assignments. All quoted material should be enclosed in quotation marks, or, if more than three lines, indented and single spaced (blocked). Quotations must be accompanied by a reference to the source. All material that is paraphrased (i.e. ideas from a source transcribed into the student's words) must be accompanied by a reference note as well. I expect you to exhibit ethical and honest work habits at all times. **All papers that use the text and other sources MUST be referenced.**

Academic Honesty Policy

The Business Program at UNH Manchester holds a **Zero Tolerance** policy with respect to academic misconduct or misrepresentation. At a minimum, any confirmed violation of academic integrity will result in a failing grade for this class and may lead to expulsion from the Business major and/or dismissal from the university. If you are at all uncertain about the definition of misconduct, plagiarism, "cheating" or "academic dishonesty" please refer to the student handbook or the university website for a full description (at: <http://www.unh.edu/student/rights/rrr0506.pdf>). Please be aware that this issue is extremely serious and any confirmed incidents will be referred to the appropriate university administrator for additional disciplinary action, including the possibility of dismissal from the university **EVEN FOR A FIRST OFFENSE!**

Student Support Services

Academic Honesty Policy

Many colleagues are making note on their syllabi of the importance of the University Academic Honesty Policy. Given the vigilance of the University in rooting out dishonesty, we strongly encourage this practice, as well as one that clearly explains your standard penalty as allowed per the [University Academic Honesty Policy](#). Many colleagues also include in their syllabi the link for the [tutorial on plagiarism](#) as well. This language is located at Resource Hub PDF section 5.0 (or web page [here](#)).

Accessibility Services

The University is committed to providing students with documented disabilities equal access to all university programs and facilities. If you think you have a disability requiring accommodations, you must register with the Student Accessibility Services (SAS) office. The Student Accessibility Coordinator at UNHM is Jenessa Zurek. Please reach out to the SAS office via email at jenessa.zurek@unh.edu for registration information and disability related questions. Jenessa Zurek is available through phone and email Mondays and Wednesdays from 9am-2pm.

Mental Health and Wellness

In partnership with The Mental Health Center of Greater Manchester, UNH Manchester offers free mental health sessions for students. Students can schedule virtual counseling sessions by emailing unhm.advising@unh.edu. Counselors will be available virtually on Monday, Tuesday, and Thursday from 9am-5pm.

The National Suicide Prevention Lifeline provides 24/7, free and confidential support via phone or chat for people in distress, resources for you or your loved ones, and best practices for professionals. Call (800) 273-TALK (8255).

Confidentiality and Mandatory Reporting

Confidentiality and Mandatory Reporting: The University of New Hampshire and its faculty are committed to assuring a safe and productive educational environment for all students and for the university as a whole. To this end, the university requires faculty members to report to the university's Title IX Coordinator (Donna Marie Sorrentino, dms@unh.edu, 603-862-2930/1527 TTY) any incidents of sexual violence and harassment shared by students. If you wish to speak to a confidential support service provider who does not have this reporting responsibility because their discussions with clients are subject to legal privilege, you can find a list of resources ([privileged confidential service providers/resources](#)). For more information about what happens when you report, how the university considers your requests for confidentiality once a report is made to the Title IX Coordinator, your rights and report options at UNH (including anonymous report options) please visit ([student reporting options](#)).

Academic Resources

Library: The UNH Manchester librarians are available to assist you with your research. You can contact a librarian by calling 603-641-4173 or by emailing unhm.library@unh.edu.

The following online resources provide information about library resources and services:

UNH Manchester Library webpage: <https://manchester.unh.edu/library>

Online Research Guides: <https://libraryguides.unh.edu/index.php?b=s>

Access Library Resources Remotely: <https://libraryguides.unh.edu/remotearchive>

Reserve a study room for Zoom classes: <https://libraryguides.unh.edu/remotearchive/studyrooms>

Center for Academic Enrichment: Provides academic support services, including individual tutoring, for all students. Make an appointment through the CAE My Courses site on your Canvas dashboard. Phone: (603) 641-4113. Email: unhm.cae@unh.edu

Food Pantry: The campus food pantry has pre-packed bags of non-perishable food items for students in room 437. If you have any questions, contact Kattarina.Biss@unh.edu

Sexual Harassment and Rape Prevention Program (SHARPP): Provides free and confidential advocacy and direct services to survivors. (<https://www.unh.edu/sharpp>.)

Face to Face Participation

My basic philosophy is that you are here as a client you are motivated and interested in business as a career, or you would not be here. My job is to help guide you on the path to success in this course, seeing myself as a coach and facilitator. Professional education always involves a level of self education and inquiry. This implies a few things:

- **Attendance and Participation Synchronous** (“face to face”) class participation will be graded with up to 10 points earned per class meeting. For active participation, a student should regularly participate and contribute to the topic under discussion. Contributions are valid and may introduce ideas that are new and/or not always readily obvious. Contributions, also, demonstrate completion of assigned readings and an ability to apply those readings to the topic.
- **Course Assignments:** Our course work is intended to further enhance the course content and work on application of the learning outcomes. Be prepared and involved in class, enjoy the process of learning about business and marketing and you will succeed. This course rewards consistent engagement. If you do miss a class, get notes from a classmate. A version of the notes accompanying slides is on Canvas. If you have any specific questions after you review someone’s notes, I’ll be happy to try and help via email, phone or zoom appointment. Missed assignments are to be avoided and lose a letter grade per day late. If you find yourself in an extraordinary situation, email me as soon as possible and we’ll discuss it. In addition, I will not offer nor accept any special assignments/extra work.

Absence Policy

With the context of a business meeting, please make all efforts to attend each of our face to face courses. The content and activities during class time help demonstrate the learning outcomes. If you do need to miss a course, you must contact me in advance of the class meeting.

Online Communication and Discussion Board Participation

Communicating in writing is much different than communicating in person and the tools we use online to interact can vary. The following recommendations should help you get started.

1. **Write clearly and concisely.** Use full sentences, including proper grammar and spelling. In other words, avoid “texting” unless requested.
2. **Maintain your personality.** When expressing opinions and perspectives, find ways to add humor, emotion, empathy, and other elements into your messages.
3. **Avoid plagiarism.** Always express yourself using your own words. When using someone else’s words to help describe or support your point, quote or credit your source.
4. **Create Drafts.** When composing long messages, emails, or discussion responses, you may want to draft them off-line first to avoid any possibility of losing your work. You can also take advantage of spell and grammar checkers when drafting off-line.
5. **Email Properly.** Always include a Subject for each email and always sign your name at the end to inform your instructor you are sending the message.

Please adhere to “Netiquette” guidelines (<http://learning.colostate.edu/guides/guide.cfm?guideid=4>) for professional online interaction. Even if they are brief, please strive to make your posts thoughtful and meaningful. Grading will be based upon the seriousness and depth of your application of and critical engagement with course material as well as your ability to engage your classmates in conversation. Please write clearly. Spelling and grammar also count.

Here are some best practices for you to follow.

- Do not dominate any discussion. Give students the opportunity to join in and lead discussions.
- Offensive language is not acceptable.
- Be cautious in regard to Internet “slang” and avoid unintended meanings. For example, do not capitalize all letters since this suggests SHOUTING.

- Do not use emojis.
- Minority opinions should be respected.
- Think and edit before you hit “send.”
- Do not hesitate to ask for help when you need it.
- Using humor is helpful but be careful that it is not misinterpreted.

For Discussion Board Participation, the purpose of the discussions is for students to interact with the course content. The instructor will read and monitor all postings, contributing as well, but the intention is for the students to take the active role. All discussion posts will be read and graded, as these are critical to understanding course content and demonstrate understanding of the course learning outcomes.

Late Policy

The expectation is for all assignments to be submitted by the assigned due date, especially as our course will cover the breadth of business topics and build on itself throughout the term.

- Late Discussion Board assignments will not be accepted for academic credit after the Sunday due date. There will be a 10% late penalty on your grade if the initial post is submitted after the Wednesday due date. There will be no discussion board submissions accepted for credit after the Sunday due date.
- For other assignments, work will be accepted for one week after the due date. Your grade will reflect a 10% late penalty.
- Exams and presentations will not be granted extensions. Late work will not be accepted.

Course Assignments

Below is a description on all of the assignments that are due. All work is to be posted on Canvas in typed format. More information will be provided on Canvas. Please make sure your first and last name, name of the course, and title of the assignment on each assignment. All assignments have to be double spaced, follow APA citations/references, and be in 11 font.

Class Participation: Our course is intended to be student driven, with classroom based activities and discussion dependent on student participation. Given this, student participation is heavily weighted. The expectation is to attend, be attentive, and actively participate in all classroom meetings.

Homework Assignments: Business is a broad and dynamic discipline. Given this, we will have several homework assignments that require you to research, reflect, and apply course content to demonstrate your understanding of the course concepts. Each assignment will be posted on Canvas, and due on Thursdays throughout the term.

Discussion Boards: The instructor views the Discussion Boards as equivalent to class discussions and participation. By engaging with your peers over the course content, it allows everyone to think critically and make sense of the material. **Initial Discussion Board posts will be due on Thursdays to allow for two peer responses to be completed by Sundays.** For Discussion Board posts, please note initial posts should have approximately 250 words, grounded in course content, and addressing the assignment prompts. Peer post (one) should be substantial and include approximately 150 words addressing the peer specific prompts. *Please note late discussion posts will not be accepted after the Module has closed given we will have moved onto a new topic. See above for more details.*

Midterm and Final Examinations:

There will be two exams (middle and end of term). All exams will be multiple choice and selected short essay questions. Each one will be based on our Business Foundations textbook, other handouts/readings, and related materials. The final exam will cover the last chapters in the book and selected major concepts covering the entire course.

Business Project:

For this term project, you will be working in groups to develop a business plan for a new business of your choosing. You can choose to create a plan for selling either a product or service. The written business plan will be accompanied by a PowerPoint presentation that your group will present in class. More information will be provided in class.

Grading

Grading:

Based on 550 possible points below.

Exam 1	11%	60 points
Exam 2	11%	60 points
Assignments (11)	20%	110 points
Discussion Boards (6)	16%	90 points
Class Participation (8)	22%	120 points
Team Business Plan Project	20%	110 points (graded as a team)
TOTAL	100%	550 points

Grading Calculation

A	520-550
A-	505-519
B+	490-504
B	475-489
B-	460-474
C+	445-459
C	430-444
C-	415-429
D+	400-414
D	390-399
D-	375-389
F	Below 374

Class Meetings & Assignments

**Please note: The instructor of this course claims the right to make additions and deletions to the syllabus and assignments as she sees fit, depending on course progress. If this happens, an announcement will be made in class.*

CLASS SESSION	TOPICS	ASSIGNMENT DUE
Week 1 Jan 30	Syllabus Review Course Protocols Dynamics of Business	• Discussion Board 1 (2/5) • Chapter 1
Week 2 Feb 6	Business Ethics Business in a Borderless World	• Chapter 2&3 • Homework 1 (2/9) • Discussion Board Initial Post (2/9) • Two Peer Responses (2/12)

Week 3 Feb 13	Organizing Business	• Chapters 4&5 • Homework 2 (2/16)
Week 4 Feb 20	Nature of Management	• Chapter 6 • Discussion Board Initial Post (2/23) • Homework 3 (2/23) • Two Peer Responses (2/26)
Week 5 Feb 27	Teamwork, Operation Management	• Chapter 7&8 • Homework 4 (3/2)
Week 6 Mar 6	Midterm Exam Chapters 1-8	• Midterm Due (3/10)
Week 7 Mar 13	Spring Break	
Week 8 March 20	Motivating Workforce and Managing Human Resources	• Chapter 9&10 • Homework 5 (3/23)
Week 9 Mar 27	Customer Driven Marketing	• Chapter 11 • Discussion Board Initial Post (3/30) • Homework 6 (3/30) • Two Peer Responses (4/2)
Week 10 Apr 3	Marketing Strategy and Digital Marketing	• Chapter 12&13 • Homework 7 (4/6)
Week 11 Apr 10	Accounting and Financial Statements	• Chapter 14 • Discussion Board Initial Post (4/13) • Homework 8 (4/13) • Two Peer Responses (4/16)
Week 12 Apr 17	Financial Management and Securities	• Chapter 15&16 • Discussion Board Initial Post (4/20) • Homework 9 (4/20) • Two Peer Responses (4/23)
Week 13 Apr 24	Managing Personal Finances	• Homework 10 (4/27)
Week 14 May 1	Review of All Chapters Pulling it All Together-Semester Summary	• Homework 11 (5/4)
Week 15 May 8	Business Plan Presentations	• Project Presentations
Week 16 May 15	Final Exam Due	• Final Exam (5/15)